

JavaScript

4.1 Introduction to JavaScript

JavaScript is what drives the web and has defined the Web 2.0 experience. No one can deny the fact that it has made the web a much more interactive place.

JavaScript was created to make the web more interactive. Although it was introduced way back in the days of Netscape, it is now available on all browsers and has been standardised by ECMA as ECMAScript. By standardised, it means it will have the same syntax and effect on all browsers.

4.2 ...of browsers and DOM

The document object model (DOM) is the browser's internal representation of the HTML page. It defines how the browser and the developer 'sees' the page. One of the biggest problems encountered while creating JavaScript code is that different browsers represent the page differently, and thus the developer's job is to first find out which browser the code is running on, and then run the appropriate code written for that browser.

In the beginning, all browsers were continuously adding features in order to gain advantage, and this led to many non-standard HTML tags, and JavaScript procedures. Over time some of those have been accepted to become a standard, such as XMLHttpRequest while many others have now depreciated.

Since the internet is a large place, the vast variety of system configurations make the developer's job all the more difficult. Even though most browsers today are trying to accommodate web standards, there is still a plethora of computer users who are using older browsers.

You can ask all those you know to upgrade your browsers; however, updating the online community is not possible.